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# Anthropic Identifies the Jobs Most Exposed to AI Risks—Is Your Occupation Affected?

By [PETER GRATTON](#) Published March 10, 2026 12:42 PM EDT



The report argues that policy makers need to prepare for the risks of AI. Credit: Maskot / Getty Images

## KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Computer programmers, customer service, and data entry workers face the highest risk of being replaced by what AI tools can do related to

#2. **Dietitian** with a median annual salary of \$61,650 per year.



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The workers most at risk from AI aren't those earning the lowest wages, but are among the best-paid, best-educated professionals in the U.S., a new study from Anthropic has found. <sup>[1]</sup>

Unlike past waves of automation, which hit blue-collar workers hardest, AI appears to be targeting so-called "knowledge work," and the people who do it for a living may be more vulnerable than cashiers and cooks who earn far less than them. Almost three-quarters of a computer programmer's core job tasks, for instance, are already being handled by AI—not someday, but in how it's used today.

The study arrives as many Americans worry that [AI automation may cost them their jobs](#), even as most research has been theoretical about [which tasks AI might handle](#), with the most robust studies thus far showing limited effects on employment. <sup>[2]</sup> Anthropic, the company that built Claude, is one of the few organizations with direct experience with AI, making this among the more important



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|    | Occupation                                       | Observed AI Exposure |
|----|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| 1  | Computer programmers                             | 74.5%                |
| 2  | Customer service representatives                 | 70.1%                |
| 3  | Data entry keyers                                | 67.1%                |
| 4  | Medical record specialists                       | 66.7%                |
| 5  | Market research analysts                         | 64.8%                |
| 6  | Sales representatives, wholesale & manufacturing | 62.8%                |
| 7  | Financial and investment analysts                | 57.2%                |
| 8  | Software quality assurance analysts and testers  | 51.9%                |
| 9  | Information security analysts                    | 48.6%                |
| 10 | Computer user support specialists                | 46.8%                |

Observed AI exposure" measures actual automated AI usage in work settings, not theoretical capability. Data from Anthropic's Economic Index.

Table: Investopedia/Peter Gratton • Source: [Anthropic](#)

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specialists (66.7%), and financial and investment analysts (57.2%) round out the most exposed occupations. <sup>[3]</sup>

Most striking about this list is that these aren't the low-skill roles policymakers have historically worried about most in discussions about automation. Workers in the most exposed occupations earn about 47% more than workers in jobs with zero AI exposure, are far more likely to hold graduate degrees—17.4% vs. 4.5% in the zero exposure group—and are 16 percentage points more likely to be female. <sup>[4]</sup> That's because AI is targeting knowledge work, the kind involving analysis and writing.



#### WHAT THIS MEANS TO YOU

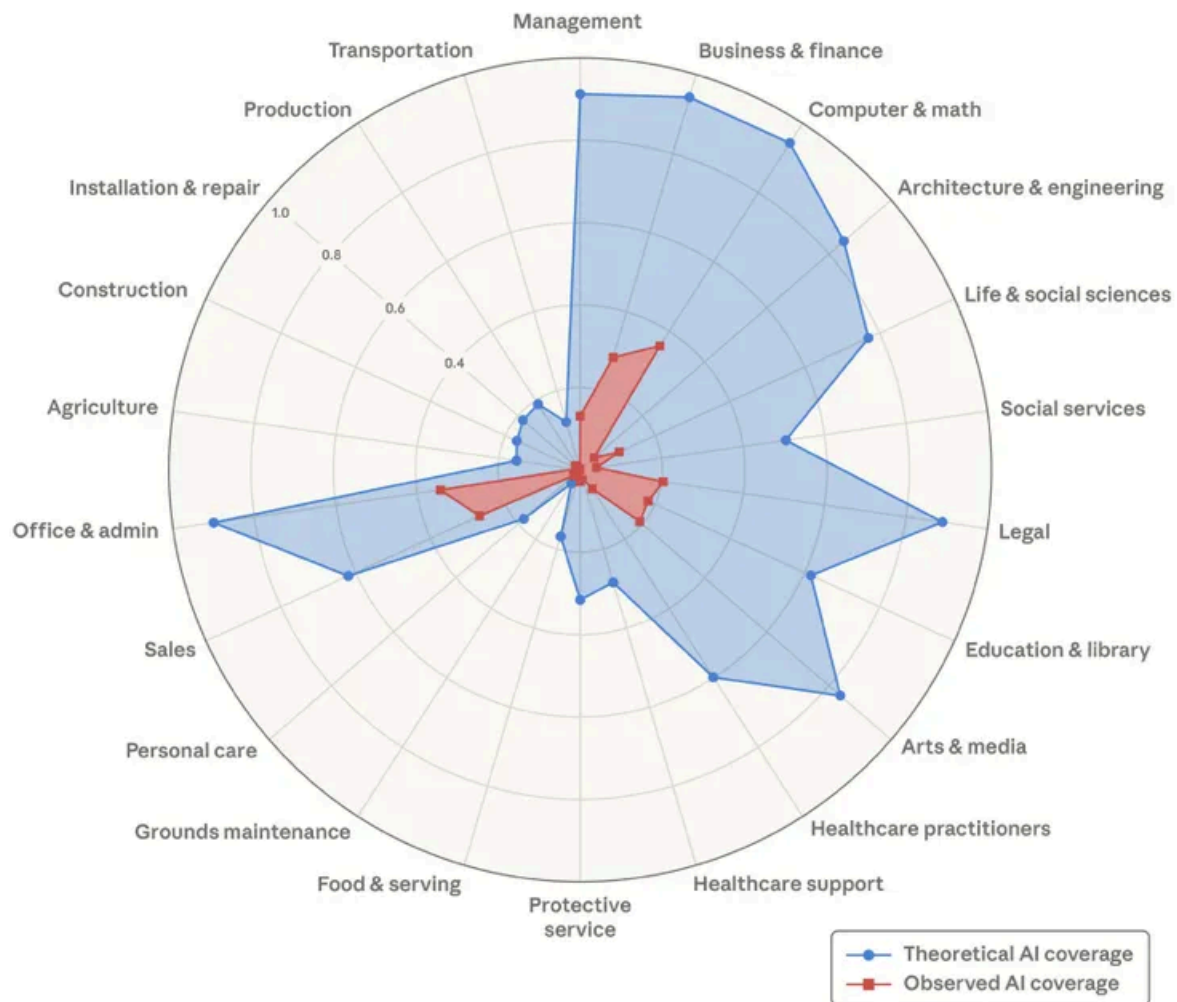
If you work in a knowledge-based field that involves programming, finance, customer service or data, AI is already likely handling a meaningful share of tasks like yours. Your job may not disappear, but the door may be closing for those coming after you, as hiring in the most AI-exposed occupations has already started to slow among the youngest workers.

## AI's Potential Reach vs. AI Usage Today

Many studies on the [risks to jobs f](#) theoretical question: what tasks *n* researchers Maxim Massenkoff and creating a measure called "observ automating in real-world, work-re

Their measure gives more weight than to cases where AI simply assi

most likely to be repla 14 Low-Stress Jobs to Consider



The blue area shows the share of job tasks that AI could theoretically perform among these occupational categories. The red area shows what AI is actually doing in professional settings today, based on real Claude usage data.

Credit: Anthropic

Most AI-related automation remains in the hands of [Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei](#), are down the corporate ladder, rendering

According to the Anthropic study, computer and math occupations. a third of those tasks. Legal work is vulnerable to AI, but Massenkoff a

field. <sup>[8]</sup> But those i 14 Low-Stress Jobs to Consider



As AI's deployment in the economy broadens, that gap should narrow, they argue, and so will job security in the occupations where it does.

## Highest AI-Risk Workers Are Better Paid and Better Educated

Demographics of workers with zero AI task coverage vs. those in the most-exposed occupations, pre-ChatGPT (August to October 2022)

|                                   | No Exposure | Most Exposed |
|-----------------------------------|-------------|--------------|
| <b>Demographics</b>               |             |              |
| Typical age                       | 41.0        | 42.9         |
| Female                            | 38.8%       | 54.4%        |
| Hispanic                          | 24.8%       | 13.8%        |
| White, non-Hispanic               | 54.5%       | 65.1%        |
| Black, non-Hispanic               | 13.2%       | 9.7%         |
| Asian, non-Hispanic               | 4.7%        | 9.1%         |
| Married                           | 44.6%       | 54.9%        |
| <b>Education level</b>            |             |              |
| Less than high school (HS)        | 13.2%       | 2.3%         |
| HS diploma                        | 38.9%       | 17.7%        |
| Some college or associates degree | 30.0%       | 25.5%        |
| Bachelor's degree                 | 13.3%       | 37.1%        |
| Graduate degree                   |             |              |
| <b>Labor market</b>               |             |              |
| Hours worked per week             |             |              |
| Hourly wage (\$)                  |             |              |
| Union member                      |             |              |

"Most exposed" reflects workers in the top quartile of AI task coverage.  
"No exposure" reflects the 30% of workers whose occupations had zero AI task coverage, based on Anthropic's usage data.

by [r Gratten](#) • Source: [Anthropic](#)

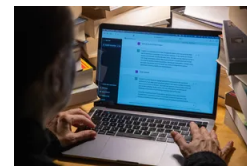
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[Dallas](#) and the Yale Budget Lab, Massenkott and McCrory's analysis of Federal  
Current Population Survey data found no meaningful increase in  
unemployment rates for these workers since [ChatGPT](#) launched in late 2022. [\[10\]](#)  
[\[2\]](#) [\[11\]](#)

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But many have pointed out that [worrying signs](#) for the future of the labor market could be at its entry point. Among workers ages 22 to 25, the rate of starting a new job in a high-AI-exposure occupation has fallen about 14% compared with 2022. Workers over 25 show no such pattern, the study found. [\[12\]](#) But Massenkoff and McCrory said there might be other reasons for these changes among the younger cohort who are not hired may be remaining or returning to school."

For now, computer programmers, and medical record specialists are caused mass layoffs are imminent move.



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